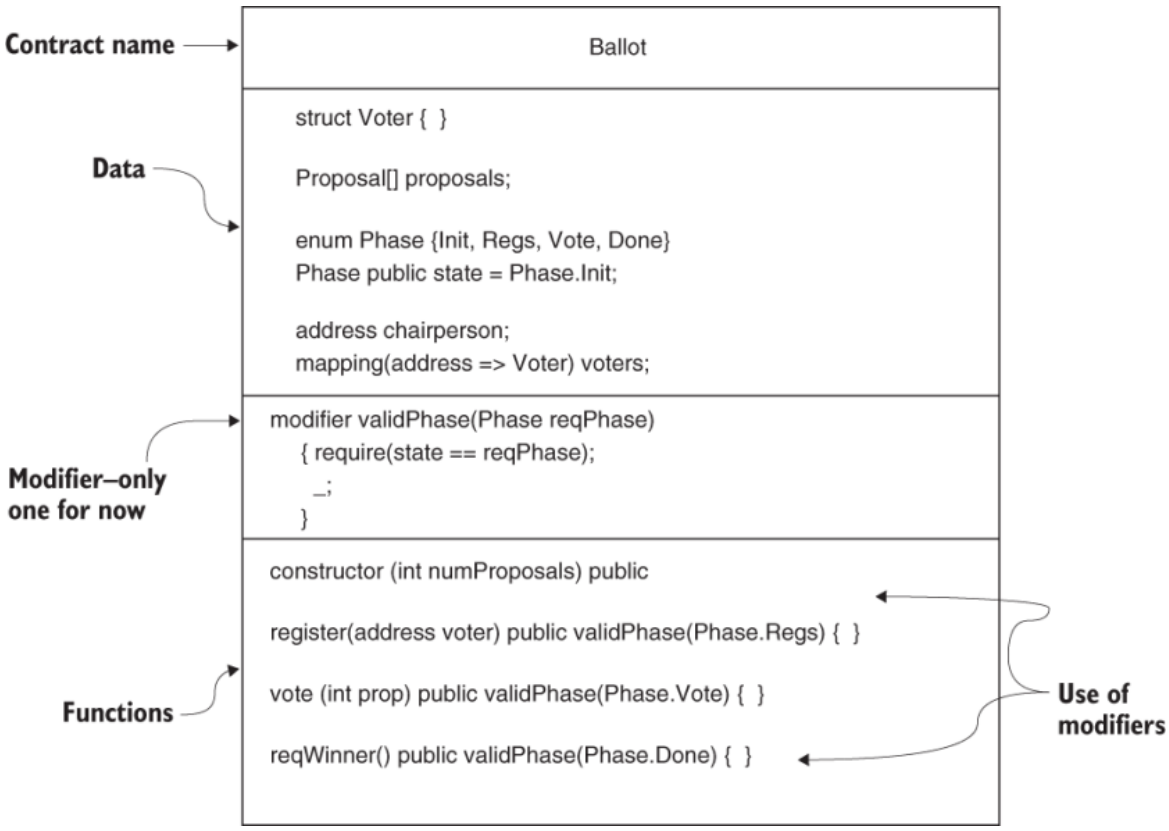


Figure 3.6 Ballot contract diagram

Note that the modifier `validPhase` has a parameter `Phase reqPhase`. In the functions box of the contract diagram, you see the repeated use of the `validPhase` modifier in the headers of three functions. Observe that the `validPhase` modifier is called with three different actual parameters--`Regs`, `Vote`, and `Done`--from the headers of the various functions, which illustrates the flexibility and reusability of the modifier. Before each function, the modifier is applied and executed with the actual parameter value. Inside the modifier, this actual parameter is compared with the current state of the voting process. If it does not match the state at the time the function is called, the function call is reverted, and it is not executed or recorded on the blockchain. This validation is the role of the modifier.